

THE AREA HOSTS
AROUND 225 DIFFERENT
VARIETIES OF BIRDS



Photographs by SHAILESH RAVAL/www.indiatodayimages.com

Porbandar TAKES WING



Gandhi's birthplace is transformed into India's fastest growing bird sanctuary attracting thousands of rare migratory birds from Europe and Siberia

By Uday Mahurkar

Mohandas Karamchand Gandhi's birthplace has a new identity: as a bird sanctuary. For the past decade or so, lakhs of migratory birds from all parts of the world have made Porbandar their winter home, settling within the city's 20-km

radius. The main draw for the winged species is that Porbandar is located on India's west coast and offers saline as well as sweet water bodies. The Gosabara dam on the city's outskirts offers a breathtaking view of thousands of flamingoes, Dalmatian and Demoiselle pelicans, cranes, pintails, pochards and tufted pochards, apart from various other

duck varieties. This season, local bird watchers sighted the rare Marble Til duck here, the second time in recorded history.

A recent bird-watching camp organised by the local branch of the Bird Conservation Society of Gujarat at Porbandar confirmed as many as 225 different varieties of birds in the area, a large number of them migrat-